

Margaret Bolton

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC 2022 – Present

- Dissertation: *"Essays on Waste Policy"*
- Committee: Profs. Zachary Brown (Co-Advisor), Ezgi Cengiz (Co-Advisor), Spencer Banzhaf, & Christopher Galik

M.S. in Analytics, Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA 2017 – 2019

M.S. in Mechanical Engineering, Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA 2003 – 2006

B.S. in Mechanical Engineering, Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA 2001 – 2003

RESEARCH FIELDS

Environmental Economics, Industrial Organization, Labor Economics

WORK EXPERIENCE

Behavioral Researcher, Duke University, Durham, NC 2018-2022

- Diagnosed potential barriers to behavior change, designed testable interventions, and analyzed the results of pilots and field experiments using statistical methods. Analyzed large-scale data sets to generate insights on behavior change, using a variety of models, including but not limited to linear regression, survival analysis, binomial and multinomial regression.

Compliance Manager, Johnson & Johnson (contracted through Artech Information Systems LLC), Remote 2015-2017

- Conducted independent audits of quality system elements at medical device manufacturing sites and design centers and provided feedback on action plans. Analyzed quality data, e.g., field actions, complaints, etc., to find relevant trends and signals and provide recommendations to senior management.

Quality Engineer/Manager, Ethicon Sàrl, a Johnson & Johnson Company, Switzerland 2010-2014

- Site quality lead for process risk assessment, process specification maintenance, development of statistical sampling plans. Project leader for value stream evaluation and project to improve process robustness, compiled and analyzed quality and manufacturing data for manufacturing process steps.

Manufacturing Engineer, Bio-Rad Laboratories, Benicia, CA 2008-2010

- Managed cross-functional teams to specify, purchase, install, and validate new processing equipment, up to \$700,000 capital expenditure. Designed and performed Measurement System Analysis (MSA) on in-process measurement instrumentation.

Equipment/Validation Engineer, GPSG, a Johnson & Johnson Company, Vacaville, CA 2005-2008

- Validation lead of new product launch team, coordinating equipment qualifications in pharmaceutical manufacturing facility. Developed and reviewed qualification and validation testing documentation

JOB MARKET PAPER

"You want a plastic bottle, pal, you're gonna pay for it: An ex ante analysis of a national tax on plastic packaging in U.S. soft drinks,"

- **Abstract:** Plastic waste poses serious risks to both the environment and human health leading some localities to adopt policies to reduce plastic waste. I use barcode-level sales, price, and product data from NielsenIQ between 2021 and 2023 on soft drinks, one of the largest users of plastic packaging, to estimate consumer demand and total volume of plastic used by the industry. I then use the demand model to simulate the impacts of different potential national weight-based plastic packaging tax rates on the usage of plastic and aluminum, a common alternative packaging material, by the soft drinks industry.

PUBLICATIONS

C. Ratcliffe, J. Burke, P. Heck, M. Bolton, and E. Saunders, "Consumer savings app strategies and savings outcomes," Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Tech. Rep. 22-9, 2023. <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4398403>.

WORKING PAPERS

"Does curbside composting increase how much food households throw away?," with Zachary Brown, Under Review

WORK IN PROGRESS

"You gotta fight for your right to repair: Will households exercise their rights to repair their goods?,"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Independent Instructor, NC State University	2025 – Present
• Introduction to Agricultural and Resource Economics: Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026	
Graduate Teaching Assistant, NC State University	2023 – 2025
• Essential Economics for Managers (Master-Level): Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025	
Graduate Teaching Assistant, Georgia Institute of Technology	2018 – 2019
• Intro to Analytics Modeling (Master-Level): Spring 2018, Fall 2018, Spring 2019	

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

Provost's Doctoral Fellowship, NC State University	2022
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PRESENTATIONS

Camp Resources Graduate Student Summer Program) (Asheville, NC)	2025
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SERVICE

Referee: Review of Environmental Economics and Policy

OTHER INFORMATION

Programming: Python, R, MATLAB

Other Skills: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Qualtrics survey development

Language: English (fluent), French (business proficiency)

REFERENCES

Prof. Zachary Brown (Co-Advisor)
Associate Professor
Dept. of Agricultural & Resource Economics
NC State University, Raleigh, NC
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Ezgi Cengiz (Co-Advisor)
Insights Manager
Global Marketing Trends & Growth
Ingredion Incorporated, Bridgewater, NJ
ezgiaksar1917@gmail.com